and skits. They were organized across cities, towns and villages – from Delhi to Kolhapur, Hyderabad to Belgaum, and Pune to Palghar.[10]

A public meeting was organized in Bombay on 25 February 1980 to discuss legal, political and social aspects of rape. Ahead of that meeting, street plays were performed and songs sung on women's liberation. A ten-minute Hindi play was performed depicting how female complainants are revictimized when filing a complaint at a police station. The meeting included broad-based discussions on rape, many of them involving keen audience participation. Karate and judo sessions were held to improve women's self-defence capabilities.[11] Marches and demonstrations were organized about two weeks later, on International Women's Day.[12]

A report from March 1980 described a protest by Adivasi women in Talasari, a town close to the Maharashtra–Gujarat border, which extended beyond rape to the socio-economic conditions of women:

> 1500 women marched to the Tahsildar's office and the police station . . . They demanded the reopening of the Mathura case . . . they spoke about rape in their own lives, by policemen, contractors, moneylenders and shopkeepers. Others spoke about the evils of alcoholism which they maintain had been introduced by the moneylenders and landlords. Some spoke on rising prices, the right to work, and the corruption in the employment guarantee scheme.[13]

The mobilization of women's groups in the aftermath of Mathura's case was unprecedented. Previously isolated women's groups drew strength from collective protests cutting across ideologies. As one editorial written ten years later put it: 'The protest was widespread, it drew women across party lines and it was unanimous.'[14] Several women's rights groups were established. This included the Forum Against Rape (later rechristened the Forum Against Oppression of Women), which circulated leaflets and circulars in different parts of the country in an attempt to gather support for the protests. One of the forum's leaflets was entitled 'Isn't It Time We Looked Rape in the Face?' It included several powerful exhortations urging society to escape the squeamishness about rape:

> Isn't it time we accepted that it [rape] does occur, all the time, everywhere? Accept that all women are potential victims – be they young or old, attractive or plain, 'nice' or 'not nice',